



BAE's Smart Skin

Tiny sensors that could pick up data on temperature, wind speed and movement is being developed as skin over planes <http://dgit.in/SmartSkinBAE>



Boogio Smart Shoes

Patent-pending sensor, that can detect 65,000 points of pressure in feet, is inside the new smart shoe <http://dgit.in/Boogio>

Geek life

about this addiction so many of us battle on a daily basis.

Why is too much information not a good thing?

Some choose to call it multitasking, but we all know that multitasking involves doing the job properly. In the words of Clifford Nass, communication professor at Stanford, "People who multi-task all the time can't filter out irrelevancy. They can't manage a working memory. They're chronologically distracted."

Is it an actual addiction?

To get to the point, yes. Digital addicts have been found to receive the same reward as a person addicted to narcotic substance. The brain releases a chemical called dopamine every time you check your facebook or twitter. Dopamine is behind the nice feeling you get when you're with your loved one or when you do something you love. Since your body now knows what will give you that warm fuzzy feeling, it wants to go back to it. Over and over again. In cases of severe substance addictions, your brain ends up producing dopamine only when you're 'doped-up'. A life where happiness is seen only when you have Diacetylmorphine Hydrochloride flowing through your veins.

While digital addiction may not be as extreme as drugs, it still is a mental illness. According to the National Institute on Drug Abuse,

[An] addiction changes the brain in fundamental ways, disturbing a person's normal hierarchy of needs and desires and substituting new priorities connected with procuring and using the drug. The resulting compulsive behaviours that override the ability to control impulses despite the consequences are similar to hallmarks of other mental illnesses.

The average digital addict today really has trouble prioritising. They wake up and check their Facebook. Instead working, they'd rather watch a video about otters and they can't sleep without tweeting 'good night' to all the people they think are following them like obsessed psychopaths. But the one obsessed here is the self and the obsession is, well, the self too.

In recent studies by Google and other organizations, it was revealed that 50 per cent of Americans prefer communicating digitally rather than face to face. 72 per cent are using their smartphones while doing something else, like watching TV and 93 per cent use their smartphone at home.

While it's not yet an official psychological disorder, 'Internet Addiction' or even 'iDisorder' has piqued the interests of so many that some clinics and even some resorts have begun offering treatment and detox packages.

Are you for real?

Yes! With the number of cellphone users climbing higher every day, the number

with your device at all times and the sheer volume of information pumped through it has left the world struggling.

Phantom rings, phantom vibrates and even the phantom presence of your device in your pockets is increasingly becoming common and we're all in need of a break.

With no time to play, the average Johnny is no longer dull but is rather constantly on edge, a rocket ready to take off, an accident waiting to happen.

Fortunately, several organizations and individuals have foreseen our impending doom. While digital detox clinics are pretty popular across the globe, the trend is catching up here in India as well. This brings us to New Delhi where we can find Centre for Children Internet and Tech-



Nothing worse than tiny fingers and sharp teeth coming at you.

of people whose lives are falling apart because they are constantly connected is growing too. Leaving the digital addicts aside, the average hard working individual is badly affected as well.

While labour laws state that the average worker is expected to work eight hours a day, the presence of a connected device in the palm of your hand has basically turned you into a machine working 24x7. And if it's not work, you are constantly inundated with digital media of all sorts. Sure it may be in the guise of entertainment, but your mind still has to keep processing it all the time. This constant demand that you need to be

nology Distress. Yes, you read that right, it's meant for children.

Located in South Delhi's Sarvodaya Enclave, children as young as ten are getting counselling here aimed at weaning them off their dependence on the internet and technology.

"Children are born into a world that's heavily dependent on technology. When they see their parents and others around them using technology, they end up using them too and become dependent. Because they are at an impressionable age and because they don't know how to balance their time between technology and the real world, they end up getting hooked,"